

## GOVERNMENT EXAM MASTER NOTES

Junior Office Associate (BPS-13)

ENGLISH — Complete Study Package

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### PART 1: GRAMMAR (20%)

Grammar is the backbone of English. In BPS-13 exams, grammar MCQs test your knowledge of rules and their application. Read each rule carefully, memorise the tricks, and practise the MCQs.

#### 1.1 PARTS OF SPEECH

##### ■ Definition

Words are classified into 8 Parts of Speech based on their function in a sentence.

■ MCQ TRICK: In MCQs, identify the function of the underlined word. The SAME word can be different parts of speech: 'The light is on.' (noun) vs 'She is light.' (adjective) vs 'Light the candle.' (verb).

■ COMMON MISTAKE: Students confuse adjectives and adverbs. Adjectives modify NOUNS; adverbs modify VERBS/ADJECTIVES/ADVERBS.

Practice MCQs — Parts of Speech

Q1. Identify the part of speech of the underlined word: 'She sings \_\_\_beautifully\_\_\_.'

- A) Adjective
- B) Adverb
- C) Noun
- D) Verb

✓ Answer: (B) Adverb → 'Beautifully' modifies the verb 'sings', so it is an adverb.

Q2. In 'The old man walked slowly', the word 'old' is a:

- A) Adverb
- B) Pronoun
- C) Adjective
- D) Conjunction

✓ Answer: (C) Adjective → 'Old' describes the noun 'man'.

Q3. Which sentence contains an interjection?

- A) She runs fast.
- B) Alas! He is dead.
- C) They go to school.

D) Birds sing sweetly.

✓ Answer: (B) Alas! He is dead. → 'Alas!' is an interjection expressing sorrow.

Q4. 'However' in 'He is lazy; however, he passes.' is a:

A) Preposition

B) Conjunction

C) Adverb

D) Noun

✓ Answer: (B) Conjunction → 'However' joins two clauses = conjunctive adverb (functions as conjunction).

Q5. The word 'fast' in 'He drives fast' is:

A) Adjective

B) Noun

C) Adverb

D) Preposition

✓ Answer: (C) Adverb → 'Fast' modifies the verb 'drives', so it is an adverb here.

## 1.2 TENSES — All 12 Types

### ■ Tense Structure Chart

### ■ Key Signal Words for Tenses

■ RULE: 'Since' is used with a point of time (since 2010, since morning). 'For' is used with a period of time (for 2 hours, for 3 years). Both are used with Perfect tenses.

■ MCQ TRICK: When you see 'since' or 'for' in MCQ: choose Present Perfect or Past Perfect. When you see 'ago': choose Simple Past (NEVER Present Perfect).

■ COMMON MISTAKE: WRONG: I have seen him yesterday. RIGHT: I saw him yesterday. ('Yesterday' = specific past time → Simple Past)

### Practice MCQs — Tenses

Q6. She \_\_\_\_\_ in this office since 2015.

A) works

B) worked

C) has worked

D) had worked

✓ Answer: (C) has worked → 'Since 2015' signals Present Perfect.

Q7. I \_\_\_\_\_ him three days ago.

A) have seen

B) had seen

C) see

D) saw

✓ Answer: (D) saw → 'Ago' requires Simple Past.

Q8. By the time he arrived, she \_\_\_\_\_ the work.

A) finished

B) has finished

C) had finished

D) was finishing

✓ Answer: (C) had finished → 'By the time he arrived' = Past Perfect.

Q9. They \_\_\_\_\_ cricket when it began to rain.

A) play

B) played

C) were playing

D) have played

✓ Answer: (C) were playing → 'When it began to rain' interrupted the ongoing action → Past Continuous.

Q10. She \_\_\_\_\_ a novel at present.

A) writes

B) wrote

C) has written

D) is writing

✓ Answer: (D) is writing → 'At present' signals Present Continuous.

Q11. He will have completed the project \_\_\_\_\_ Friday.

A) since

B) for

C) by

D) ago

✓ Answer: (C) by → 'By Friday' is used with Future Perfect.

Q12. Water \_\_\_\_\_ at 100°C.

A) boils

B) is boiling

C) boiled

D) has boiled

✓ Answer: (A) boils → Scientific fact / universal truth = Simple Present.

Q13. I \_\_\_\_\_ for two hours before he called.

- A) wait
- B) waited
- C) had been waiting
- D) have waited

✓ Answer: (C) had been waiting → Ongoing action before another past action = Past Perfect Continuous.

### 1.3 ACTIVE & PASSIVE VOICE

#### ■ Rules for Changing Active to Passive

■ RULE: Steps: 1) Object becomes Subject. 2) Add correct 'be' verb. 3) Main verb becomes V3. 4) Add 'by + old subject' (optional if unknown).

■ MCQ TRICK: Pronoun changes in passive: I→me, he→him, she→her, they→them, we→us. Also me→I, him→he, etc. when moving to subject position.

■ EXAMPLE: Active: She wrote a letter. → Passive: A letter was written by her. (NOT: by she)

■ COMMON MISTAKE: Do NOT add 'by' when the agent is unknown or unimportant. 'The road was built.' is correct without 'by someone.'

#### Practice MCQs — Active & Passive Voice

Q14. Change to passive: 'The teacher is teaching the students.'

- A) The students are taught by the teacher.
- B) The students are being taught by the teacher.
- C) The students were being taught by the teacher.
- D) The students have been taught by the teacher.

✓ Answer: (B) The students are being taught by the teacher. → Present Continuous passive = is/are being + V3.

Q15. Passive of: 'They had completed the work.'

- A) The work is completed by them.
- B) The work was completed by them.
- C) The work had been completed by them.
- D) The work has been completed by them.

✓ Answer: (C) The work had been completed by them. → Past Perfect passive = had been + V3.

Q16. Active form of: 'A letter was written by him.'

- A) He wrote a letter.
- B) He has written a letter.
- C) He had written a letter.
- D) He writes a letter.

✓ Answer: (A) He wrote a letter. → 'Was written' = Simple Past passive → Simple Past active.

Q17. Choose the correct passive: 'She will finish the report.'

- A) The report is finished by her.
- B) The report will be finished by her.
- C) The report will have been finished by her.
- D) The report was finished by her.

✓ Answer: (B) The report will be finished by her. → Simple Future passive = will be + V3.

Q18. Which sentence is in passive voice?

- A) Birds sing sweetly.
- B) The cake was eaten.
- C) She is cooking food.
- D) They played cricket.

✓ Answer: (B) The cake was eaten. → 'Was eaten' = past tense of 'be' + V3 = passive.

#### 1.4 DIRECT & INDIRECT (REPORTED) SPEECH

##### ■ Tense Back-Shift Table

##### ■ Pronoun & Time/Place Changes

■ RULE: Reporting Verbs: Statements→said/told. Questions→asked/inquired. Commands→told/ordered/requested. Requests→requested. Exclamations→exclaimed.

■ MCQ TRICK: For YES/NO questions in indirect: use 'if' or 'whether'. For WH-questions: use the WH-word itself. Word order becomes STATEMENT order (no inversion).

■ EXAMPLE: Direct: He said, 'I am tired.' → Indirect: He said that he was tired. | Direct: She said, 'Are you coming?' → Indirect: She asked if I was coming.

##### Practice MCQs — Direct & Indirect Speech

Q19. Direct: He said, 'I will come tomorrow.' → Indirect:

- A) He said that he will come the next day.
- B) He said that he would come the next day.
- C) He said that he comes the next day.
- D) He told he would come tomorrow.

✓ Answer: (B) He said that he would come the next day. → 'will'→'would', 'tomorrow'→'the next day', 'I'→'he'.

Q20. She said, 'I am reading a book.' → Indirect:

- A) She said she is reading a book.
- B) She said she was reading a book.
- C) She told she read a book.

D) She said she had been reading a book.

✓ Answer: (B) She said she was reading a book. → Present Continuous → Past Continuous.

Q21. He said to me, 'Do you live here?' → Indirect:

A) He asked me if I lived here.

B) He asked me if I lived there.

C) He asked me whether I live here.

D) He told me if I lived there.

✓ Answer: (B) He asked me if I lived there. → Yes/No question uses 'if/whether', 'here'→'there', tense back-shifted.

Q22. The teacher said, 'Open your books.' → Indirect:

A) The teacher said to open our books.

B) The teacher told us to open our books.

C) The teacher asked to open books.

D) The teacher ordered open books.

✓ Answer: (B) The teacher told us to open our books. → Commands: reporting verb + object + to-infinitive.

Q23. 'May you live long!' → Indirect:

A) She said that may you live long.

B) She wished that I might live long.

C) She prayed that I may live long.

D) She exclaimed to live long.

✓ Answer: (B) She wished that I might live long. → Exclamatory wishes: 'prayed/wished that' + might.

## 1.5 SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

### ■ Core Rules

■ MCQ TRICK: 'News, information, furniture, advice, luggage, equipment, homework' = ALWAYS singular. Remember them as a group!

■ COMMON MISTAKE: WRONG: The news are good. RIGHT: The news is good. | WRONG: Either of them are wrong. RIGHT: Either of them is wrong.

### Practice MCQs — Subject-Verb Agreement

Q24. Neither the manager nor the employees \_\_\_\_\_ responsible.

A) is

B) was

C) are

D) has been

✓ Answer: (C) are → Neither...nor: verb agrees with nearer subject 'employees' (plural) → are.

Q25. The committee \_\_\_\_\_ decided to postpone the meeting.

- A) have
- B) are
- C) has
- D) were

✓ Answer: (C) has → Collective noun 'committee' = singular → has.

Q26. Each of the boys \_\_\_\_\_ done his homework.

- A) have
- B) are
- C) has
- D) were

✓ Answer: (C) has → 'Each' = singular → has.

Q27. The news about the floods \_\_\_\_\_ shocking.

- A) are
- B) were
- C) is
- D) have been

✓ Answer: (C) is → 'News' = uncountable, always singular → is.

Q28. Mathematics \_\_\_\_\_ my favourite subject.

- A) are
- B) were
- C) is
- D) have been

✓ Answer: (C) is → Academic subjects ending in -ics = singular.

### 1.6 ARTICLES (a, an, the)

■ RULE: 'a/an' is determined by SOUND, not spelling. 'University' starts with 'yoo' sound (consonant) → use 'a'. 'Hour' starts with 'ow' sound (vowel) → use 'an'.

■ MCQ TRICK: 'The' is used before: rivers (the Nile), mountain ranges (the Himalayas), oceans (the Pacific), newspapers (the Dawn), superlatives (the best), and unique objects (the sun, the moon, the earth).

■ COMMON MISTAKE: WRONG: She is an university student. RIGHT: She is a university student. | WRONG: He is an honest man? RIGHT: He IS an honest man. ('Honest' = silent H, sounds like vowel.)

Practice MCQs — Articles

Q29. She is \_\_\_\_\_ honest woman.

- A) a
- B) an
- C) the
- D) no article

✓ Answer: (B) an → 'Honest' begins with vowel sound /■/ (H is silent) → 'an'.

Q30. He is \_\_\_\_\_ European.

- A) a
- B) an
- C) the
- D) no article

✓ Answer: (A) a → 'European' begins with /j/ (consonant sound) → 'a'.

Q31. \_\_\_\_\_ sun rises in the east.

- A) A
- B) An
- C) The
- D) No article

✓ Answer: (C) The → Unique objects take 'the'.

Q32. She plays \_\_\_\_\_ piano beautifully.

- A) a
- B) an
- C) the
- D) no article

✓ Answer: (C) the → Musical instruments take 'the'.

Q33. He is \_\_\_\_\_ MBA.

- A) a
- B) an
- C) the
- D) no article

✓ Answer: (B) an → 'MBA' read as 'em-bee-ay' starts with vowel sound → 'an'.

### 1.7 PREPOSITIONS

■ MCQ TRICK: at (point/time/small place) → in (period/large area) → on (day/date/surface). Think: at 5, in May, on Monday.



■ COMMON MISTAKE: WRONG: He is good in English. RIGHT: He is good AT English. |  
WRONG: I am waiting since 2 hours. RIGHT: I have been waiting FOR 2 hours.

#### Practice MCQs — Prepositions

Q34. She has been living here \_\_\_\_\_ 2018.

- A) for
- B) since
- C) from
- D) at

✓ Answer: (B) since → 2018 = point of time → 'since'.

Q35. The book is \_\_\_\_\_ the table.

- A) in
- B) at
- C) on
- D) by

✓ Answer: (C) on → Surface → 'on'.

Q36. He divided the cake \_\_\_\_\_ the five children.

- A) between
- B) among
- C) with
- D) for

✓ Answer: (B) among → More than two → 'among'.

Q37. I will call you \_\_\_\_\_ Monday.

- A) in
- B) at
- C) on
- D) by

✓ Answer: (C) on → Day name → 'on'.

Q38. He is good \_\_\_\_\_ mathematics.

- A) in
- B) at
- C) on
- D) with

✓ Answer: (B) at → Fixed expression: good AT (a subject).

#### 1.8 CONJUNCTIONS

■ MCQ TRICK: FANBOYS = For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So — the 7 coordinating conjunctions. They join INDEPENDENT clauses with a COMMA before them.

■ COMMON MISTAKE: WRONG: He studied hard, but he passed. (This is correct — contrast.) WRONG: He is absent because he is sick. (No comma needed before 'because'.) RIGHT: He is absent because he is sick.

Practice MCQs — Conjunctions

Q39. She was tired \_\_\_\_\_ she kept working.

- A) but
- B) or
- C) so
- D) for

✓ Answer: (A) but → 'But' shows contrast between two ideas.

Q40. \_\_\_\_\_ he works hard, he will not succeed.

- A) If
- B) Unless
- C) Although
- D) Since

✓ Answer: (B) Unless → 'Unless' = if not → negative condition.

Q41. Not only Ali \_\_\_\_\_ Sara passed the exam.

- A) and
- B) but also
- C) or
- D) nor

✓ Answer: (B) but also → Correlative pair: not only...but also.

Q42. He was ill; \_\_\_\_\_, he came to office.

- A) therefore
- B) however
- C) moreover
- D) because

✓ Answer: (B) however → 'However' = despite that (contrast).

Q43. Choose the correct sentence:

- A) She sings but dances.
- B) She neither sings or dances.
- C) She neither sings nor dances.
- D) She either sings nor dances.

✓ Answer: (C) She neither sings nor dances. → Correlative: neither...nor (always paired).

### 1.9 MODAL VERBS

■ MCQ TRICK: Modal verbs NEVER change form — no -s, -ed, -ing. After modals: always use BASE FORM (V1). 'She cans speak' is WRONG. 'She can speak' is RIGHT.

■ COMMON MISTAKE: WRONG: He must to go. RIGHT: He must go. | WRONG: She could went. RIGHT: She could go. (Modal + V1, never V2)

#### Practice MCQs — Modals

Q44. You \_\_\_\_\_ not smoke here. (Strong prohibition)

- A) should
- B) could
- C) must
- D) would

✓ Answer: (C) must → 'Must not' = strong prohibition.

Q45. When I was young, I \_\_\_\_\_ swim very fast.

- A) can
- B) could
- C) will
- D) should

✓ Answer: (B) could → Past ability = 'could'.

Q46. \_\_\_\_\_ I use your pen? (Polite permission)

- A) Will
- B) Shall
- C) May
- D) Must

✓ Answer: (C) May → 'May' is used for polite permission.

Q47. You \_\_\_\_\_ see a doctor immediately.

- A) must
- B) should
- C) would
- D) could

✓ Answer: (B) should → 'Should' = advice.

Q48. He \_\_\_\_\_ visit us every Sunday when he lived nearby.

- A) will
- B) would

C) should

D) must

✓ Answer: (B) would → 'Would' = past habit.

### 1.10 CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

■ RULE: In Type 2 conditionals, use 'were' for ALL subjects (not 'was'): 'If I were you...' / 'If she were here...' This is a formal rule tested in exams.

■ MCQ TRICK: Look at the IF-clause tense to identify type: Present→Type 1, Past→Type 2, Past Perfect→Type 3. Then choose the correct main clause formula.

#### Practice MCQs — Conditionals

Q49. If she \_\_\_\_\_ harder, she would pass the exam.

A) studies

B) studied

C) had studied

D) will study

✓ Answer: (B) studied → Type 2 (unreal present): if + Simple Past → would + V1.

Q50. If it \_\_\_\_\_ tomorrow, we will cancel the trip.

A) rained

B) rains

C) would rain

D) had rained

✓ Answer: (B) rains → Type 1 (real future): if + Simple Present → will + V1.

Q51. If I \_\_\_\_\_ you, I would apologise.

A) am

B) was

C) were

D) had been

✓ Answer: (C) were → Type 2: always 'were' (not 'was') in formal/exam English.

Q52. If they \_\_\_\_\_ the map, they wouldn't have got lost.

A) have

B) had

C) had had

D) would have

✓ Answer: (C) had had → Type 3 (unreal past): if + Past Perfect → would have + V3.

Q53. Water \_\_\_\_\_ at 100°C. (Zero conditional)

- A) boils
- B) will boil
- C) would boil
- D) boiled

✓ Answer: (A) boils → Zero conditional: both clauses in Simple Present.

### 1.11 GERUNDS & INFINITIVES

#### ■ Key Verb Lists

■ RULE: 'remember/forget + gerund' = action done in the past. 'remember/forget + infinitive' = action to be done in the future.

■ EXAMPLE: I remember meeting him. (I met him, and I remember it.) | I must remember to call him. (I need to call him in the future.)

■ MCQ TRICK: If the verb is a PREPOSITION's complement, always use GERUND. 'She is good at playing chess.' (NOT 'to play')

#### Practice MCQs — Gerunds & Infinitives

Q54. She enjoys \_\_\_\_\_ in the rain.

- A) to walk
- B) walk
- C) walking
- D) walked

✓ Answer: (C) walking → 'Enjoy' is always followed by gerund (-ing).

Q55. He refused \_\_\_\_\_ the order.

- A) following
- B) follow
- C) to follow
- D) followed

✓ Answer: (C) to follow → 'Refuse' is always followed by infinitive (to + V).

Q56. I stopped \_\_\_\_\_ when I saw the police. (stopped the action)

- A) to drive
- B) drive
- C) driving
- D) driven

✓ Answer: (C) driving → 'Stop + gerund' = stopped the action itself.

Q57. Please avoid \_\_\_\_\_ in public.

- A) to smoke
- B) smoked

- C) smoke
- D) smoking

✓ Answer: (D) smoking → 'Avoid' + gerund.

Q58. She is good at \_\_\_\_\_ problems.

- A) to solve
- B) solve
- C) solved
- D) solving

✓ Answer: (D) solving → After a preposition ('at'), use gerund.

### 1.12 DEGREES OF COMPARISON

■ MCQ TRICK: Conversion: Positive→Superlative: 'No other student is as good as Ali' = 'Ali is the best student.' Learn to convert between all three degrees.

■ COMMON MISTAKE: WRONG: She is more taller than me. RIGHT: She is taller than me. (Never use 'more' WITH -er form.)

#### Practice MCQs — Degrees of Comparison

Q59. Superlative of 'bad' is:

- A) baddest
- B) most bad
- C) worst
- D) worse

✓ Answer: (C) worst → Irregular: bad → worse → worst.

Q60. Change to comparative: 'No other boy in the class is as tall as Ali.'

- A) Ali is the tallest boy.
- B) Ali is taller than any other boy.
- C) Ali is tall.
- D) Ali is most tall.

✓ Answer: (B) Ali is taller than any other boy. → Positive to Comparative: 'taller than any other'.

Q61. Choose the correct sentence:

- A) She is more smarter than him.
- B) She is the most smartest.
- C) She is smarter than him.
- D) She is smart than him.

✓ Answer: (C) She is smarter than him. → Do not use 'more' with -er comparative.

Q62. The comparative of 'little' is:

- A) littler
- B) lesser
- C) less
- D) smaller

✓ Answer: (C) less → Irregular: little → less → least.

Q63. 'Gold is \_\_\_\_\_ valuable than silver.' Fill in the blank:

- A) most
- B) more
- C) much
- D) very

✓ Answer: (B) more → Comparative form requires 'more' before longer adjectives.

### 1.13 SENTENCE CORRECTION & ERROR DETECTION

#### ■ Top 20 Error Types in Government Exams

■ MCQ TRICK: Countable nouns → MANY / FEWER. Uncountable nouns → MUCH / LESS. 'Less people' is always wrong in formal English → 'Fewer people'.

Practice MCQs — Error Detection

Q64. Find the error: 'She came back return from the market.'

- A) came back
- B) return
- C) from
- D) the market

✓ Answer: (B) return → 'Return' already means 'come back' — 'back' or 'return' is redundant.

Q65. Find the error: 'Neither Ali nor his friends was present.'

- A) Neither
- B) nor
- C) was
- D) present

✓ Answer: (C) was → Neither...nor: verb agrees with nearer subject 'friends' (plural) → 'were'.

Q66. Find the error: 'He plays the piano more better than his brother.'

- A) plays
- B) more better
- C) than
- D) his brother

✓ Answer: (B) more better → Double comparative: 'more better' → 'better'.

Q67. Find the error: 'Between you and I, this is wrong.'

A) Between

B) you

C) and I

D) this is wrong

✓ Answer: (C) and I → After preposition 'between', use object pronoun: 'me' not 'I'.

Q68. Correct the sentence: 'She don't know nothing about it.'

A) She don't know anything about it.

B) She doesn't know nothing about it.

C) She doesn't know anything about it.

D) She don't know nothing.

✓ Answer: (C) She doesn't know anything about it. → Double negative: 'don't...nothing' → 'doesn't...anything'.

## PART 2: VOCABULARY (10%)

2.1 TOP 150 SYNONYMS & ANTONYMS — Government Exam Words

2.2 ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS (Frequently Tested)

2.3 IMPORTANT IDIOMS & PHRASES

2.4 COMMONLY CONFUSED WORDS

## PART 3: ANALYTICAL REASONING (10%)

### 3.1 NUMBER SERIES

#### ■ Common Patterns

■ MCQ TRICK: STEP 1: Find differences between consecutive terms. STEP 2: If differences are constant → arithmetic. If differences form a pattern → second-level difference. STEP 3: Look for squares/cubes if differences don't help.

Practice MCQs — Number Series

Q69. 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, \_\_\_\_

A) 36

B) 40

C) 42

D) 44

✓ Answer: (C) 42 → Differences: 4,6,8,10 → next diff=12 → 30+12=42.

Q70. 1, 4, 9, 16, 25, \_\_\_\_

A) 30



B) 36

C) 34

D) 32

✓ Answer: (B) 36 → Squares:  $1^2, 2^2, 3^2, 4^2, 5^2 \rightarrow 6^2=36$ .

Q71. 3, 9, 27, 81, \_\_\_\_

A) 162

B) 243

C) 180

D) 254

✓ Answer: (B) 243 → Geometric:  $\times 3$  each time.  $81 \times 3 = 243$ .

Q72. 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13, \_\_\_\_

A) 19

B) 21

C) 20

D) 24

✓ Answer: (B) 21 → Fibonacci:  $8+13=21$ .

Q73. 5, 11, 23, 47, \_\_\_\_

A) 89

B) 95

C) 93

D) 97

✓ Answer: (B) 95 → Each term  $\times 2 + 1$ :  $47 \times 2 + 1 = 95$ .

### 3.2 ALPHABET SERIES

#### ■ Alphabet Position Chart

■ MCQ TRICK: Memorise EJOTY: E=5, J=10, O=15, T=20, Y=25. Use this to quickly find any letter's position (e.g., R = T-2 = 20-2 = 18).

■ EXAMPLE: A, C, E, G, \_\_\_\_ → Skip one letter each time → Answer: I | AZ, BY, CX, DW, \_\_\_\_ → A+Z=27, B+Y=27 (pair pattern) → Answer: EV

#### Practice MCQs — Alphabet Series

Q74. B, D, F, H, \_\_\_\_

A) I

B) J

C) K

D) L

✓ Answer: (B) J → Skip one letter: B(2),D(4),F(6),H(8) → J(10).

Q75. Z, X, V, T, \_\_\_\_

A) Q

B) R

C) S

D) P

✓ Answer: (B) R → Backward, skip one: Z,X,V,T → R.

Q76. A, B, D, G, K, \_\_\_\_

A) P

B) O

C) N

D) Q

✓ Answer: (A) P → Differences: +1,+2,+3,+4 → K+5=P.

Q77. AZ, BY, CX, \_\_\_\_

A) DW

B) EV

C) DV

D) EW

✓ Answer: (A) DW → First letter: A,B,C→D. Second: Z,Y,X→W → DW.

Q78. Opposite letter of F is:

A) T

B) U

C) S

D) V

✓ Answer: (B) U → Opposite of F(6):  $26+1-6=21=U$ .

### 3.3 CODING-DECODING

#### ■ Common Coding Methods

Practice MCQs — Coding-Decoding

Q79. If ROSE = TQUG, then LILY = ?

A) NKNA

B) NKNB

C) MKNA

D) NJNA

✓ Answer: (A) NKNA → Each letter +2: L→N, I→K, L→N, Y→A = NKNA.

Q80. If CAT = 3120, then DOG = ?

A) 4157

B) 4715

C) 4715

D) 4175

✓ Answer: (B) 4715 → A=1,B=2...: D=4,O=15,G=7 → 4,15,7 = 4157. (Concatenated: 4157)

Q81. If BOOK is coded as CPPL, then DOOR = ?

A) EPPS

B) EOOS

C) EOOOR

D) EOOOR

✓ Answer: (A) EPPS → Each letter +1: D→E,O→P,O→P,R→S = EPPS.

Q82. If WATER = XBUFS, the code is:

A) +2

B) +1

C) -1

D) ×2

✓ Answer: (B) +1 → W→X,A→B,T→U,E→F,R→S = each +1.

Q83. In a code, PENCIL = 17-5-14-3-9-12. What does 16-1-16-5-18 mean?

A) PAPER

B) PAGER

C) PAPER

D) PAVER

✓ Answer: (A) PAPER → P=16,A=1,P=16,E=5,R=18 = PAPER.

### 3.4 BLOOD RELATIONS

■ MCQ TRICK: Draw a family tree when solving blood relation problems. Start from the KNOWN person. Use M=Male, F=Female symbols. Never assume gender from name alone.

Practice MCQs — Blood Relations

Q84. Pointing to a girl, Ali said, 'She is the only daughter of my grandfather's only son.' How is the girl related to Ali?

A) Sister

B) Niece

C) Cousin

D) Daughter

✓ Answer: (A) Sister → Grandfather's only son = Ali's father. Father's only daughter = Ali's sister.

Q85. A is B's father. C is A's sister. D is C's mother. How is D related to B?

A) Grandmother

B) Aunt

C) Mother

D) Great-grandmother

✓ Answer: (A) Grandmother → A=B's father. C=A's sister. D=C's mother = A's mother = B's grandmother.

Q86. If X is the brother of Y, Y is the sister of Z, Z is the son of M, how is X related to M?

A) Son

B) Daughter

C) Brother

D) Nephew

✓ Answer: (A) Son → Z is M's son. Y is Z's sister → Y is also M's child. X is Y's brother → X is also M's son.

Q87. P is Q's father. R is Q's sister. S is R's mother. How is P related to S?

A) Son

B) Husband

C) Brother

D) Father

✓ Answer: (B) Husband → S is R's mother and R is Q's sister. P is Q's father. So P and S are parents of the same children → Husband.

Q88. A woman introduces a man as 'the son of my mother's only son-in-law'. How is the man related to the woman?

A) Nephew

B) Son

C) Brother

D) Cousin

✓ Answer: (B) Son → Mother's only son-in-law = the woman's husband. His son = her son.

### 3.5 DIRECTION SENSE

#### ■ Key Rules

- Starting direction is always NORTH unless stated.
- Right turn = 90° clockwise. Left turn = 90° anti-clockwise.

- After 2 right turns = facing opposite direction. After 4 right turns = back to start.
- To find shortest distance: draw the path, then use Pythagoras (if right-angle triangle).

■ MCQ TRICK: Use a simple compass diagram: N at top, S at bottom, E at right, W at left. Mark each step. Calculate final displacement using Pythagoras: distance =  $\sqrt{(\text{East-West})^2 + (\text{North-South})^2}$ .

#### Practice MCQs — Direction Sense

Q89. A man walks 5 km North, then turns right and walks 3 km. He then turns right again and walks 5 km. What direction is he facing now?

- A) North
- B) South
- C) East
- D) West

✓ Answer: (B) South → N → turned right (East) → turned right (South). Facing South.

Q90. A man faces West. He turns 90° clockwise. Which direction is he facing?

- A) North
- B) South
- C) East
- D) West

✓ Answer: (A) North → West + 90° clockwise = North.

Q91. After turning right from South, a person faces:

- A) North
- B) East
- C) West
- D) South

✓ Answer: (C) West → South + right turn = West.

Q92. Ali walks 4 km East then 3 km North. What is the shortest distance from starting point?

- A) 7 km
- B) 5 km
- C) 6 km
- D) 4 km

✓ Answer: (B) 5 km → Pythagoras:  $\sqrt{(4^2+3^2)} = \sqrt{(16+9)} = \sqrt{25} = 5$  km.

Q93. Sara faces North-East. She turns 180°. She now faces:

- A) North-West
- B) South-East

C) South-West

D) North-East

✓ Answer: (C) South-West → 180° from North-East = South-West.

### 3.6 ANALOGIES

#### ■ Common Analogy Types

■ MCQ TRICK: State the relationship in words first: 'Book is to \_\_\_\_\_ as Pen is to Writing.' If you can express it clearly, you can find the answer. The relationship must be EXACTLY the same.

#### Practice MCQs — Analogies

Q94. Doctor : Hospital :: Teacher : \_\_\_\_

A) School

B) Library

C) Office

D) Clinic

✓ Answer: (A) School → Doctor works in hospital. Teacher works in school.

Q95. Pen : Writing :: Knife : \_\_\_\_

A) Cutting

B) Sharpening

C) Fighting

D) Cooking

✓ Answer: (A) Cutting → Tool to function: pen is used for writing, knife is used for cutting.

Q96. Lion : Cub :: Dog : \_\_\_\_

A) Kit

B) Pup

C) Foal

D) Fawn

✓ Answer: (B) Pup → Young of lion = cub. Young of dog = pup (puppy).

Q97. Ornithology : Birds :: Seismology : \_\_\_\_

A) Seas

B) Earthquakes

C) Stars

D) Plants

✓ Answer: (B) Earthquakes → Ornithology = study of birds. Seismology = study of earthquakes.

Q98. Cold : Hot :: Wet : \_\_\_\_

- A) Rain
- B) Dry
- C) Dark
- D) Cool

✓ Answer: (B) Dry → Antonym analogy: Cold↔Hot :: Wet↔Dry.

### 3.7 ODD ONE OUT

#### ■ Approach

- Find what 3 items have in COMMON that the 4th does NOT have.
- Categories to check: Type, Function, Size, Colour, Starting letter, Number, Living/Non-living.

■ MCQ TRICK: Don't go with the 'obvious' answer. Check ALL possible categories. Sometimes a number series question disguises an odd one out.

#### Practice MCQs — Odd One Out

Q99. Rose, Jasmine, Lotus, Oak

- A) Rose
- B) Jasmine
- C) Lotus
- D) Oak

✓ Answer: (D) Oak → Rose, Jasmine, Lotus are flowers. Oak is a tree.

Q100. 2, 3, 7, 11, 14

- A) 2
- B) 3
- C) 14
- D) 11

✓ Answer: (C) 14 → 2,3,7,11 are prime numbers. 14 is not prime.

Q101. Dog, Cat, Parrot, Crocodile

- A) Dog
- B) Cat
- C) Parrot
- D) Crocodile

✓ Answer: (D) Crocodile → Dog, Cat, Parrot are common pets. Crocodile is a reptile, not a typical pet.

Q102. Eye, Ear, Nose, Ankle

- A) Eye
- B) Ear

C) Nose

D) Ankle

✓ Answer: (D) Ankle → Eye, Ear, Nose are sensory organs on the head. Ankle is a joint on the leg.

Q103. B, D, F, G, H

A) B

B) D

C) F

D) H

✓ Answer: (C) F → B(2),D(4),F(6),H(8) are even-position letters. G(7) is odd-position.

### 3.8 SYLLOGISM

#### ■ Types of Statements

■ RULE: Key Rules: All A=B + All B=C → All A=C (valid). All A=B + Some B=C → Some A may be C (uncertain). If one statement is particular (Some), conclusion is also particular. If one statement is negative, conclusion must be negative.

■ MCQ TRICK: Draw Venn diagrams for complex syllogisms. Shade the Universal Negative first. The conclusion must be TRUE in ALL possible diagrams, not just one.

Practice MCQs — Syllogism

Q104. All dogs are animals. All animals are living beings. Conclusion: All dogs are living beings.

A) Definitely True

B) Possibly True

C) Definitely False

D) Cannot say

✓ Answer: (A) Definitely True → All A=B, All B=C → All A=C. Valid conclusion.

Q105. Some books are pens. All pens are pencils. Conclusion: Some books are pencils.

A) Definitely True

B) Possibly True

C) Definitely False

D) None of these

✓ Answer: (A) Definitely True → Some A=B, All B=C → Some A=C. Valid.

Q106. No cat is a dog. All dogs are animals. Conclusion: No cat is an animal.

A) True

B) False

C) Possibly True



D) Uncertain

✓ Answer: (B) False → Cats and dogs are separate. Cats CAN be animals too. Conclusion is false.

Q107. All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Conclusion:

A) Socrates is immortal.

B) Socrates is mortal.

C) Some men are Socrates.

D) None of these

✓ Answer: (B) Socrates is mortal. → Classic syllogism: All A=B, C=A → C=B.

Q108. Some flowers are red. Some red things are beautiful. Conclusion: Some flowers are beautiful.

A) True

B) False

C) Possibly True

D) Cannot be determined

✓ Answer: (D) Cannot be determined → Some A=B, Some B=C → Uncertain (the 'some' may not overlap). Cannot determine.

## EXAM PREPARATION SECTION

### GRAMMAR RULES QUICK REVISION SHEET

### ONE DAY BEFORE EXAM — REVISION NOTES

#### ■ Top Tips for Last-Day Preparation

- Revise ALL tense formulas. Focus on signal words (since/for/ago/already/yet).
- Revise Subject-Verb agreement rules: each/every/neither = singular.
- Quick-scan vocabulary list: focus on synonyms/antonyms of 100+ words.
- Read the one-word substitution table — 10+ words guaranteed in exam.
- Recall all modal verbs and their uses.
- Practice 5 number series and 5 direction sense questions mentally.
- Remember: FANBOYS (coordinating conjunctions), EJOTY (alphabet positions).
- Sleep 7–8 hours before exam. Eat well. Arrive 20 min early.
- Read ALL options before choosing. Eliminate obviously wrong choices first.
- In MCQs, first find the RULE, then apply it — never guess without a reason.

## ANALYTICAL REASONING SHORTCUTS

### COMPLETE MOCK TEST — 30 MCQs (BPS-13 Style)

Time: 30 minutes | Each question: 1 mark | Total: 30 marks

■ Section A: Grammar (12 questions)

Q1. She has been working here \_\_\_\_\_ five years.

- A) since
- B) for
- C) from
- D) at

✓ Answer: (B) for → Period of time → 'for'.

Q2. Neither the manager nor the staff \_\_\_\_\_ present.

- A) was
- B) were
- C) is
- D) has been

✓ Answer: (B) were → Staff (plural) is nearer subject → 'were'.

Q3. Change to passive: 'They are building a new hospital.'

- A) A new hospital is built.
- B) A new hospital was being built.
- C) A new hospital is being built.
- D) A new hospital will be built.

✓ Answer: (C) A new hospital is being built. → Present Continuous passive: is/are + being + V3.

Q4. He said, 'I am very tired.' (Indirect speech)

- A) He said he is very tired.
- B) He said that he was very tired.
- C) He told that he is very tired.
- D) He said that he is tired.

✓ Answer: (B) He said that he was very tired. → Present→Past; I→he; 'that' added.

Q5. If I \_\_\_\_\_ you, I would work harder.

- A) am
- B) was
- C) were
- D) had been

✓ Answer: (C) were → Type 2 conditional: always 'were'.

Q6. She is good \_\_\_\_\_ solving problems.

- A) in

B) at

C) on

D) for

✓ Answer: (B) at → Good AT + noun/gerund.

Q7. Identify the error: 'He is more cleverer than his brother.'

A) He is

B) more cleverer

C) than

D) his brother

✓ Answer: (B) more cleverer → Double comparative: 'more cleverer' → 'cleverer'.

Q8. The news \_\_\_\_\_ very alarming.

A) are

B) were

C) is

D) have been

✓ Answer: (C) is → 'News' = uncountable, singular verb.

Q9. They enjoy \_\_\_\_\_ in the rain.

A) to walk

B) walk

C) walking

D) walked

✓ Answer: (C) walking → 'Enjoy' + gerund.

Q10. May I \_\_\_\_\_ your pen? (permission)

A) borrow

B) borrowing

C) borrowed

D) to borrow

✓ Answer: (A) borrow → After modal verb: base form (V1).

Q11. The number of students \_\_\_\_\_ increasing.

A) are

B) were

C) is

D) have

✓ Answer: (C) is → 'The number of' = singular.

Q12. \_\_\_\_\_ honest man is respected everywhere.

- A) A
- B) An
- C) The
- D) No article

✓ Answer: (B) An → 'Honest' begins with vowel sound → 'an'.

■ Section B: Vocabulary (9 questions)

Q13. Synonym of ABUNDANT:

- A) Scarce
- B) Plentiful
- C) Empty
- D) Rare

✓ Answer: (B) Plentiful → Abundant = Plentiful (more than enough).

Q14. Antonym of DILIGENT:

- A) Hardworking
- B) Careful
- C) Lazy
- D) Active

✓ Answer: (C) Lazy → Diligent = hardworking; antonym = Lazy.

Q15. One who can speak many languages:

- A) Bilingual
- B) Polyglot
- C) Linguist
- D) Multilingual

✓ Answer: (B) Polyglot → Polyglot = one who speaks many languages.

Q16. Meaning of 'By hook or by crook':

- A) Unfairly
- B) By any means
- C) Slowly
- D) With effort

✓ Answer: (B) By any means → Idiom: by any method, fair or unfair.

Q17. Choose the correct word: 'Her \_\_\_\_\_ to the problem was accepted.' (counsel)

- A) advice
- B) advise

- C) advised
- D) advisement

✓ Answer: (A) advice → 'Advice' is the noun form.

Q18. Synonym of ELOQUENT:

- A) Quiet
- B) Articulate
- C) Confused
- D) Loud

✓ Answer: (B) Articulate → Eloquent = fluent and expressive = Articulate.

Q19. Murder of one's father is called:

- A) Matricide
- B) Patricide
- C) Infanticide
- D) Fratricide

✓ Answer: (B) Patricide → Patricide = killing of one's father.

Q20. Antonym of LENIENT:

- A) Kind
- B) Gentle
- C) Strict
- D) Soft

✓ Answer: (C) Strict → Lenient = not strict; antonym = Strict.

Q21. Choose correct: 'There are \_\_\_\_\_ students in the hall.'

- A) less
- B) much
- C) fewer
- D) little

✓ Answer: (C) fewer → 'Students' = countable → 'fewer'.

■ Section C: Analytical Reasoning (9 questions)

Q22. Complete the series: 3, 6, 11, 18, 27, \_\_\_\_

- A) 36
- B) 38
- C) 40
- D) 42

✓ Answer: (C) 40 → Differences: 3,5,7,9,11 →  $27+13=40$ .

Q23. Complete: B, E, H, K, \_\_\_\_

- A) M
- B) N
- C) O
- D) L

✓ Answer: (B) N → Skip 2 letters: B(2)→E(5)→H(8)→K(11)→N(14).

Q24. Odd one out: 9, 16, 25, 35, 49

- A) 9
- B) 16
- C) 35
- D) 49

✓ Answer: (C) 35 →  $9=3^2, 16=4^2, 25=5^2, 49=7^2$ . 35 is not a perfect square.

Q25. If MANGO = 13-1-14-7-15, then APPLE = ?

- A) 1-16-16-12-5
- B) 1-14-16-12-5
- C) 1-16-14-12-5
- D) 2-16-16-12-5

✓ Answer: (A) 1-16-16-12-5 → A=1, P=16, P=16, L=12, E=5 = 1-16-16-12-5.

Q26. A is B's brother. B is C's father. How is A related to C?

- A) Father
- B) Uncle
- C) Brother
- D) Grandfather

✓ Answer: (B) Uncle → B is C's father. A is B's brother. So A is C's uncle.

Q27. A man walks 3 km East then 4 km South. Distance from start:

- A) 5 km
- B) 7 km
- C) 6 km
- D) 4 km

✓ Answer: (A) 5 km → Pythagoras:  $\sqrt{(3^2+4^2)} = \sqrt{25} = 5$  km.

Q28. Dog : Kennel :: Bee : \_\_\_\_

- A) Stable
- B) Hive
- C) Nest

D) Den

✓ Answer: (B) Hive → Dog lives in kennel; bee lives in hive.

Q29. All roses are flowers. Some flowers fade quickly. Conclusion:

A) All roses fade quickly.

B) Some roses fade quickly.

C) No roses fade.

D) Cannot be determined.

✓ Answer: (D) Cannot be determined. → All A=B, Some B=C → Some A=C is uncertain.  
Cannot be determined.

Q30. Complete: 1, 4, 9, 16, \_\_\_\_, 36

A) 20

B) 25

C) 30

D) 27

✓ Answer: (B) 25 → Squares:  $1^2, 2^2, 3^2, 4^2, 5^2, 6^2 \rightarrow 5^2=25$ .

YOU ARE FULLY PREPARED — GO ACE THAT EXAM!

These notes cover all major topics for the Junior Office Associate (BPS-13) English paper.  
Review Grammar rules daily, memorise Vocabulary words in groups of 20, and solve at least 10 Analytical Reasoning questions per day. Trust your preparation.